

WING INJURIES

Raptor Center releases rehabilitated bald eagle today at wildlife refuge

A six-month old bald eagle brought to Huntersville's Carolina Raptor Center in May with injuries to both wings will be released this morning at Alligator River National Wildlife Refuge near Manteo.

The eagle was found near Pea Island National Wildlife Refuge with wounds to both wings. It was taken to Roanoke Island Veterinary Clinic in Manteo where Dr Mark Grossman examined the bird and provided immediate treatment.

The eagle was then transferred to Elizabeth Hanrahan, a licensed wildlife rehabilitator based in Edenton, who arranged to move the eagle to the Raptor Center on May 28.

There it received extensive medical care and rehabilitation under the care of staff veterinarian Dr. David Scott, volunteers and staff in preparation for release into the wild.

In particular, the young eagle's blood was tested for lead and mercury levels as both chemicals have been

found in small quantities in many of the eagles admitted to CRC over the past 5 years. Eagles serve as important indicator species regarding the health of our environment.

After several weeks of recuperation, the eagle was placed in a 100-foot outdoor flight cage for exercise in preparation for its release.

Since inception, Carolina Raptor Center has released more than 5,000 injured and orphaned raptors, including 36 bald eagles.